

Ceph Community Event Planning Guide

A Practical, Step-by-Step Manual for Hosting a Ceph Event Anywhere in the World



Overview

How to host a Ceph Days event or a Ceph meetup in any city.

The first version of this guide was written by Lauren Grob (OSNEXUS), based on Ceph Days Seattle 2025. Costs vary by region, so treat the Seattle numbers as rough benchmarks.

Questions? Contact the Ceph Foundation Community Manager, Anthony Middleton (amiddleton@linuxfoundation.org), or the Ceph Ambassadors.

Step 0: Decide if you're planning a meetup or an event

	Meetup	Event
Size	Under ~50 people	Typically 50–200+ attendees
Format	Informal, a few hours	Structured, with speakers, catering, and sponsorship
Cost to attend	Free	May charge a registration fee
LF requirements	None. Can use LF-provided Bevy or Zoom if desired	Must use LF-approved registration platforms, include required legal language, and comply with LF trademark guidelines

See the [LF Project Community Events page](#) for details. **Ceph Days are almost always events.**

Planning a meetup

Meetups don't need LF resources. Pick a date, a place, and a few hours, and keep it free. If you want to use LF-provided Bevy or Zoom, contact the Ceph Community Manager.

If your meetup grows past about 50 people, or adds speakers, catering, or sponsors, it becomes an event. Follow the rest of this guide.

Planning a Ceph Days event

Required before you start

All of these are mandatory for Ceph Days events.

1. **Sign the LF Community Event Agreement.** Community-hosted events require a signed [Linux Foundation Community Event Agreement](#). This agreement can be redlined as needed. Contact the Ceph Foundation (support@cephfoundation.org) with questions.
2. **Request a registration platform.** All events collecting registrations must use an LF-approved system (Cvent, Bevy, or RegFox). RegFox is the recommended option for Ceph Days. If you are collecting registration fees for a Ceph Foundation event, you **must** use an official LF system. Submit the [Linux Foundation Event Registration Request Form](#) to get access. For details on platform options, see the [LF Project Community Events](#) page.
3. **Follow LF trademark guidelines.** The Ceph trademark is owned by LF Projects, LLC on behalf of the Ceph Foundation. All event materials (registration pages, signage, promotional assets) must comply with the [Linux Foundation Trademark Usage](#) guidelines. For logo files and color scheme requirements, see ceph.io/en/logos and ceph.io/en/trademarks.
4. **Include required legal language on your registration page.** Your RegFox (or other LF-approved) registration form must include the following privacy notice:

By submitting this form, you understand that the data included herein will be submitted to The Linux Foundation. Personal data collected from this registration form is subject to The Linux Foundation Privacy Policy. Your registration and attendance at the event will be associated with your LFX individual profile, available at <https://openprofile.dev>, and will be visible to your employer through your company's LFX organization dashboard.

Your registration data will be provided to [HOST ORGANIZATION NAME] as the host of this Ceph Days event, and is subject to their own privacy policy.

Replace [HOST ORGANIZATION NAME] with the actual hosting company name.

Budget & Timeline Overview

Timeline at a glance

When	Task
10–12 weeks out	Find sponsors
8–12 weeks out	Book date and venue, create registration page

8–10 weeks out	Launch CFP, post event on ceph.io
6–8 weeks out	Start event assets (design, banners, stickers)
4–6 weeks out	Pick speakers, book videographer, start promotion
4–5 weeks out	Build the schedule
3–4 weeks out	Order t-shirts and swag
2–3 weeks out	Order food and drinks, start paid ads
1–2 weeks out	Print badges
Event day	Check in attendees
Within 1 week	Close registration, pay invoices, send survey
Within 1–2 weeks	Send recap to the Community Manager

Typical Budget Range

These are general guidelines based on public event data. Actual costs may vary by city, venue, attendance, and scope.

The highest costs are usually venue rental, catering and drinks, t-shirts and swag, video production, and paid ads. Get quotes before going to the Ceph Foundation Events Committee.

Ceph Days Seattle 2025 costs, for reference:

Item	Cost
Venue (SURF Cafe)	\$1,500 for the day (\$200/hour)
RegFox	Free, small fee per registrant
T-shirt design contest (99designs)	\$218
Pop-up banners (FedEx Office)	\$190 each
36 T-shirts, front and back print (VistaPrint)	\$665
50 carabiners	\$62
Custom tablecloth	\$226
Food and drinks	~\$1,000
Two coffee urns	\$200

Beverage cooler	\$179
Videographer (8 hours)	\$1,200
LinkedIn ads	\$1,800
Clear badge protectors	\$20

Step 1) How to Secure Sponsors.

Typical Time: Start 10–12 weeks before the event

Most Ceph Days have 1–3 sponsors who share costs and visibility. Start with the current list of Ceph Foundation members and look for companies with local offices, active Ceph teams, a strong regional presence, or nearby customers and partners.

Where to get help:

- The Community Manager can introduce you to sponsorship decision-makers and confirm alignment with Foundation guidelines.
- Governing Board members each represent an organization that may sponsor. They can point you to the right internal contact.
- If you already have a sponsor in mind, share their info with the Community Manager.

Your outreach should cover what Ceph Days are, expected audience (usually 50–200), an estimated date window, a budget overview, sponsor benefits (visibility, a speaking spot, community engagement), and a request for a short call.

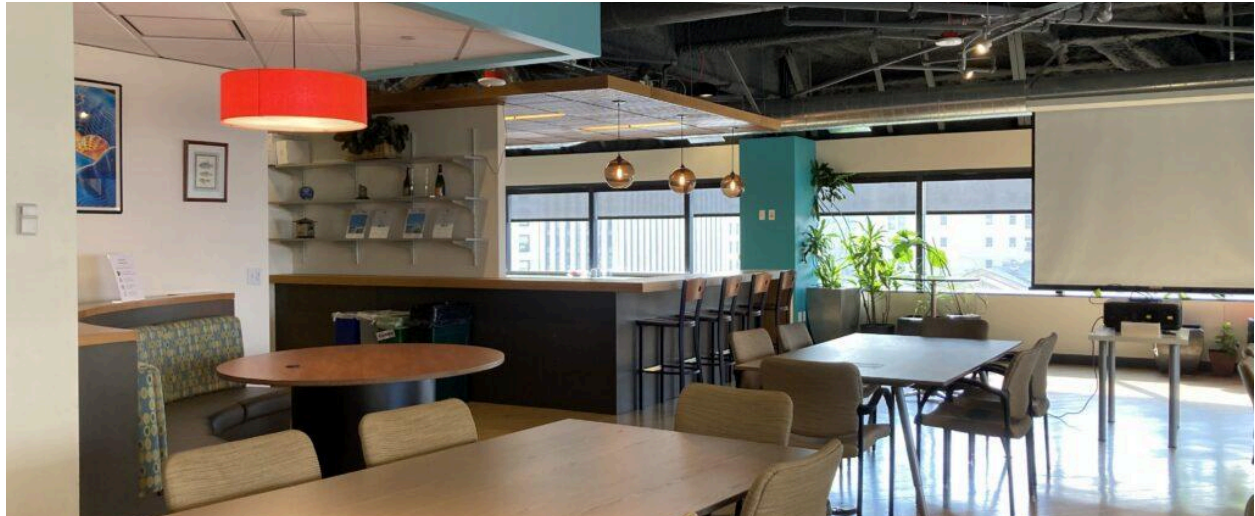
Step 2) Confirmation of Venue and Registration Page

A: Secure Date, Time, and Venue

8–12 weeks out

Know who the event is for and what it's meant to do. Pick a date and block out 9 am–5 pm or 12–8 pm. Sponsors can sometimes host at their local office. Otherwise, rent a venue. Peerspace is a good place to search.

Seattle example: Thursday, May 15, 12–8 pm, SURF Cafe, downtown Seattle.

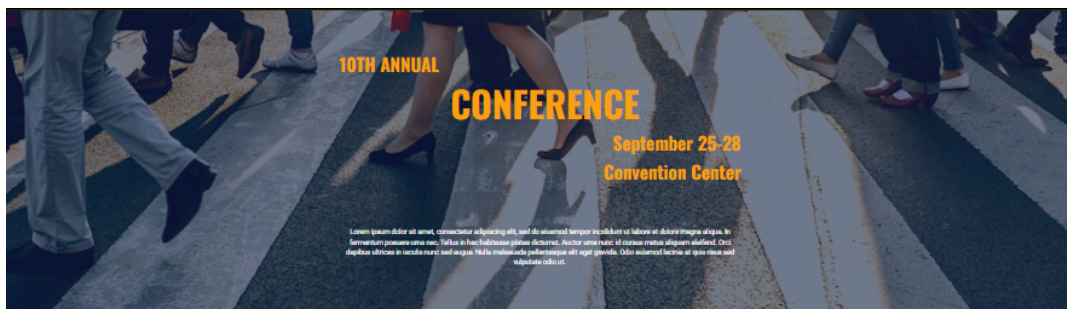


Step 3: Create the registration page

8–12 weeks out

Using the RegFox access you requested earlier, build your registration page with all event details. Make sure it's linked from the event's ceph.io page.

RegFox Example Page



KEYNOTE SPEAKER



John Smith, CEO

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[VIEW WEBSITE](#)

AGENDA

Monday, 8 AM // Registration is Open

Tuesday, 9 AM // Keynote Session Begins

Tuesday, 1 PM // Breakout Sessions Begin

Wednesday, 9 AM // Exhibit Hall Open

REGISTRATION OPTIONS

Please select one option*

- ☐ Full Conference (\$175.00)
- ☐ Speaker Only (\$150.00)
- ☐ Exhibit Only (\$150.00)

Cost: Free with minimal fees per registrant.

Step 4: Launch the CFP and post the event on ceph.io

8–10 weeks out

Ask your Ceph Foundation contact to post the event on the Ceph Events page and create a Call for Papers form from the existing Google Forms template. Decide on CFP deadlines and when to announce.

Gaurav Sitlani, Ceph Ambassador Lead (gsitlani@redhat.com), can help with the CFP and with getting the event onto ceph.io.

Seattle example page: <https://ceph.io/en/community/events/2025/ceph-day-seattle/>

Step 5: Create event assets

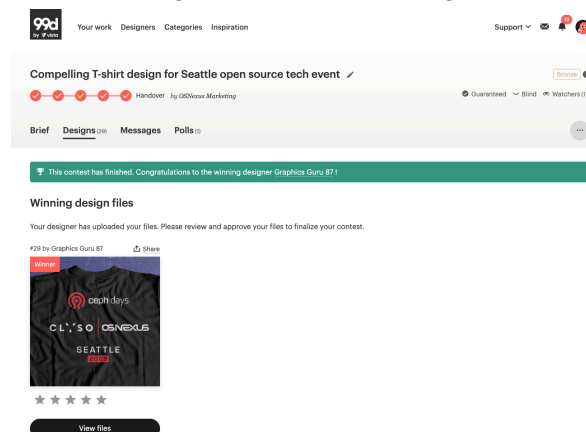
Begin 6–8 weeks out

All assets must follow the Ceph Foundation trademark policy. You may not change the Ceph Marks or color scheme. See <https://ceph.io/en/trademarks/> and <https://ceph.io/en/logos/>.

You'll need assets for online promotion and for event day (t-shirts, pop-up banners, stickers).

- **Design:** 99designs runs affordable design contests. Seattle used a Bronze contest with a guaranteed prize and blind entries.
- **Banners:** Have the same designer create pop-up banners that point guests to your event.
- **Stickers:** [StickerApp](https://www.stickerapp.com/).

Example: Cost: \$218 for a T-shirt design contest on 99designs.



Use the same designer for your T-shirts and have them create pop-up banner designs to direct guests to your event on the day of.

- Example: Ceph Days Seattle pop-up banners below.
- Cost: \$190 each at FedEx Office.

For the design contest, please see this folder for examples from previous Ceph Days. Folder here: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1OVquGi4rNNJa_auSizrbbbFmEYcQG83M

Step 6: Choose speakers and build the schedule

Pick speakers 4–6 weeks out; finish the schedule 4–5 weeks out

Review CFP submissions with your Ceph Foundation contacts. Talks should interest the Ceph community and fit the Ceph Foundation's values (see the [About the Ceph Foundation](#) page).

For an 8-hour event, plan 6–8 speakers with 10- to 30-minute slots. A typical schedule includes an opening welcome, morning sessions, a lunch break, afternoon sessions, networking time, and closing remarks. Leave breaks for food, restrooms, and conversation.

- Example: Ceph Days Seattle speaker list below.

Step 7: Order t-shirts and swag

3–4 weeks out

[VistaPrint](#) ships fast and covers t-shirts, tablecloths, and giveaways. Reuse your t-shirt design files for the tablecloth to avoid extra design work. The Ceph Foundation also has a tablecloth you can borrow on request.



Step 8: Order food and drinks

2–3 weeks out

Go with affordable, popular options. Ask the venue which caterers they trust rather than trying someone new. Bulk stores like Costco work well. Check with the venue about coffee urns, coolers, and utensils.

Seattle served Costco pastries, coffee and tea, sodas, beer, wine, and fruit, with Ezell's Famous Chicken and BLOOM Seattle for dinner.

Step 9: Book a videographer (optional)

4–6 weeks out

Have each talk filmed as its own segment so you can edit later. Seattle used Sandpiper. See all video footage from Ceph Days Seattle here: [Ceph Days Seattle presentations](#).

Step 10: Promote the event

Start 4–6 weeks out; paid ads 2–3 weeks out.

Channels: ceph.io, your organization's website, sponsor websites, email, social media, and meetup.com. The Community Manager can post on all Ceph Foundation social channels.

For paid ads (for example, LinkedIn), start at least 3 weeks before the event. Most people make plans late, so earlier spend is less effective. Test different ad versions and keep what works.

Seattle used sponsored posts on the OSNEXUS company page, then Sponsored InMails closer to the date.

Step 11: Print badges

1–2 weeks out

RegFox can print badges with registrant info and logos. Order clear badge holders and lanyards (cost: ~\$20).

- Example: Ceph Days Seattle badge below.

Step 12: Event day

Pick up fresh items (ice, drinks, food) and bring badges, the tablecloth, and swag. Check attendees in with the RegFox app, which also tracks attendance data.

- Example/cost: Total cost breakdown for Ceph Days Seattle is below for your reference.

Event Expenses	Cost	Notes
Venue	\$1,499.20	
99designs t-shirt design contest	\$218	
t-shirts	\$665.46	36 quantity
Coffee urns	\$196.36	
Beverage cooler	\$179	
Carabiners for giveaway	\$62.50	
99designs for pop up banner design	\$147	
video services	\$1,200	
catering	\$792.30	
costco for food/bev/supplies	\$338.96	
LinkedIn advertising	\$1,794.67	
Contractor for LinkedIn InMail campaign	\$750	
Retractable banners	\$411.02	
Plastic badge protectors	\$20.93	
Custom table cover	\$226.61	
TOTAL	\$8,275.40	
Minus Registration Sales	\$350	13 people at \$25 each
ACTUAL TOTAL	\$7,925.40	

Step 13: After the event

Within 1 week:

- Close your RegFox registration page.
- Complete payout setup in RegFox to collect ticket funds.
- Settle invoices, handle video footage, and do post-event promotion.
- Send attendees a survey. Example: <https://forms.gle/1KkvzR57t28onDP9>

After your event, please email a recap to the Ceph Community Manager at amiddleton@linuxfoundation.org.

Your event recap should include the following:

- RSVPs and total attendees
- Budgeted vs. actual cost
- Photos and video links
- Session recordings
- Feedback
- Lessons learned / suggestions for next organizers

How Registration Payments Work

If your Ceph Days event charges a registration fee (whether to cover catering, venue costs, or other expenses), it's important to understand how payments flow through the Linux Foundation's financial systems.

Payment Flow

All registration fees collected through RegFox are deposited into the Linux Foundation's bank account. Credit card processing fees are deducted automatically before the funds arrive. The LF Events team then manually codes the revenue to the Ceph Foundation's project financials.

Linux Foundation G&A

The Linux Foundation applies its standard General & Administrative (G&A) fee to all registration revenue collected. This is consistent with how all project funds are handled across the Foundation.

Reimbursing a Host Organization

A common scenario is when a company hosts a Ceph Days event at its own space and charges a registration fee to cover costs like food and beverages. In this case, the payment process works as follows:

1. Registration fees are collected via RegFox and deposited into the LF bank account (minus credit card processing fees).
2. The LF Events team confirms the total revenue received for the event after it concludes.
3. The G&A fee is applied to the revenue and retained by the Linux Foundation.
4. The remaining balance is available to reimburse the host organization.
5. The host organization submits an invoice to the Linux Foundation for their eligible expenses, and payment is made through the standard LF accounts payable process.

Key Points for Organizers

- **You cannot direct RegFox payments to a non-LF bank account.** All funds must flow through the Linux Foundation.
- **Plan for the G&A fee and processing fees** when setting your registration price. The amount available for reimbursement will be less than the total collected.
- **The host organization must invoice the LF** to receive reimbursement. Coordinate with the Ceph Foundation (support@cephfoundation.org) to ensure proper invoicing and payment.

For questions about payments and financial processes, contact the Ceph Foundation at support@cephfoundation.org.